上海交通大學
SHANGHAI JIAO TONG UNIVERSITY

TC3000J
Technical Communication

Resume and Cover Letter

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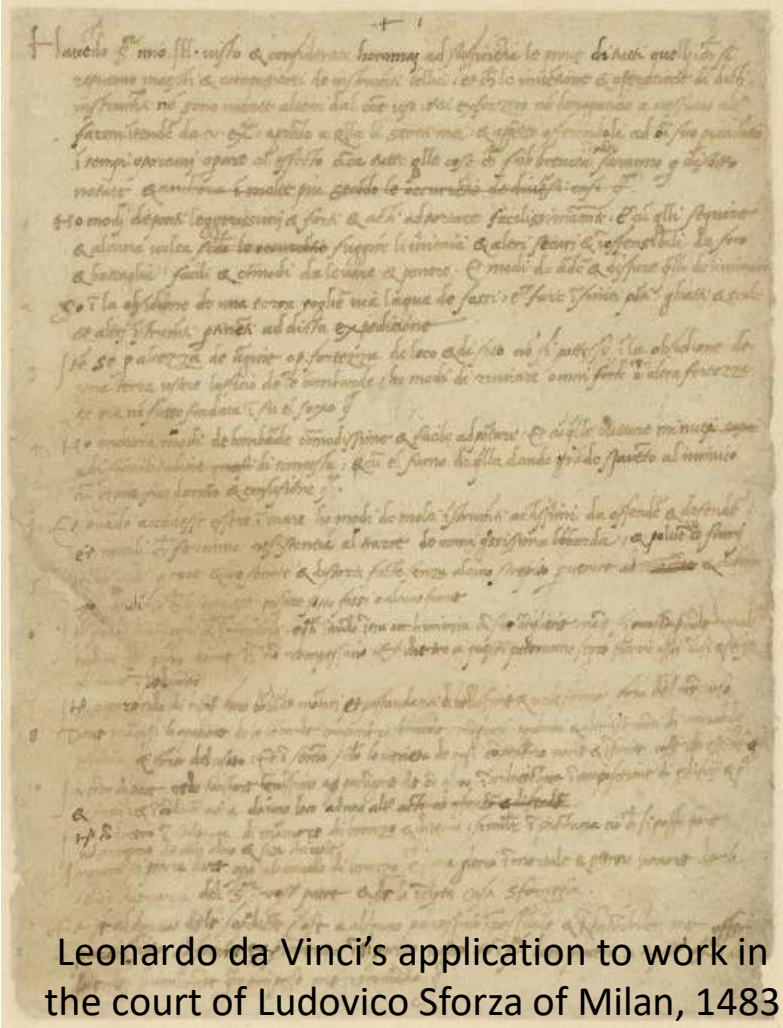
CV and Resume

Historical Perspective



Leonardo da Vinci's application to work in the court of Ludovico Sforza of Milan, 1483

"A CV—short for the Latin "curriculum vitae," meaning "course of life"—is **a detailed document highlighting your professional and academic history."**

-------Indeed

https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/resumes-cover-letters/what-is-a-cv

Resume and CV Objectives

	Resume	CV
Use case	Non-academic positions	Academic, public, or pedagogic positions
Length	One page, in exceptions two	Normally two or more pages
Structure	No strict requirement	Chronological categories
Content	Individual and on-point relevant experiences	Complete Information
Purpose of Document	Explaining the own fit for the position	Explaining academic achievements and career path
1st Audience	HR	Admission Officer
Further Audience	Line manager, BU Leader etc.	Admission Committee/Panel

Characteristics of a Strong Resume

Focus

Your professional skills: contains directly relevant information
-Job description, company activities

Organization

Experiences listed in reverse chronological order, with several bullet points per item

Layout

Standard font with simple layout

Correctness

Free from any language or grammar errors

Sections of a CV

Header	Name and Job title in larger font, contact info neatly below
Photo (maybe)	A professional photo of you
Employment	Company, job title, location, dates, responsibilities
Education	University, graduation date, coursework, GPA, recognitions
Skills and Certifications	Including language skills
Awards and Honours	Academic awards, honours, and grants
Extracurricular Activities	If relevant
Publications	If applicable

Cover Letter
and
Statement of Purpose

Cover Letter

Contact Information

Date

Salutation

First Paragraph

- Provide information on how you found out about the job and why you're applying. Mention the precise job title

Middle Paragraphs

- Relevant skills
- Related specific experiences
- Highlights

Final Paragraph

- Acknowledgement
- Follow up

Complimentary Close

Signature

Statement of Purpose

A comprehensive story about YOU.

- Personal, vivid, logical, consistent theme

Motivations

- Genuine
- Career goals match the **school/university** and the specific **program**
- Legacy to live up to

Excellence

- Relate specific experiences and observable or measurable achievements relevant to the desired program
- Highlights

What can you offer in return?

- Influencing others? Creative? Genius? High profile in research?

Know the requirements:

- Specified questions?
- Font, Spacing, Margins?
- Word or page Limits?

Drafting

Plan your essay

- Core story
- Free-write to get all your ideas out, then cut and reorganize into paragraphs

Gather information about your target program from its website/brochures

- Faculty and their specialisations: rankings, reviews, news
- Courses offered, to compare them to the courses you have taken
- Their pride and values

Connect to your story

- Your own experiences and understanding
- Gathered information about the specific university/school/program

Have your essay proofread by peers and faculty advisers

Polish/rewrite accordingly

- Zero mistake in spelling, grammar, usage, etc.
- Make every word work for you.

Paragraphs

Paragraph Organization

- By knowledge requirements
  (e.g., programming, data structures)
- By experience
  (e.g., academic, internship, extracurricular)

Paragraph Cohesion

- “One paragraph, one idea”
- Logical flow between paragraphs

Best Practices

Avoid	Implement
• Overusing emotions (e.g., “thrilled”, “excited”) • Talking in general terms about wanting to make the world a better place • Overloading the reader with as many experiences as you can • Using contractions (e.g., can’t → cannot, it’s → it is) • Use the same letter for all schools • Flattering • Begging/ pleading • Justifying negative points/excuses • Reciting the CV • Risky strategies	• Structure each paragraph around a few carefully selected experiences which are tied to specific needs of your target school or organization • Specify the degree level and major you are seeking • Provide objective, descriptive examples • Define technical terms in one or two words, and write out the full name of a term before using abbreviations • Organize the essay so that each paragraph has one focus, and the paragraphs transition smoothly • Use plain language, active voice • Plan ahead • Follow the defined instructions

Action Words

Creative			Research		
Conceptualized	Customized	Designed	Analysed	Assessed	Created
Generated	Ideated	Launched	Developed	Discovered	Evaluated
Reviewed	Strategized	Transformed	Gathered	Improved	Measured
Shaped	Sketched	Crafted	Compiled	Investigated	Surveyed
Drafted	Prototyped	Assembled	Examined	Explored	Audited
Negotiation			**Technical**		
Arranged	Cultivated	Demonstrated	Analysed	Coded	Conducted
Developed	Established	Originated	Developed	Diagnosed	Implemented
Secured	Strengthened	Updated	Modeled	Programmed	Reviewed
Leveraged	Collaborated	Spearheaded	Optimized	Delivered	Updated
Mediated	Arbitrated	Settled	Designed	Engineered	Aggregated
Management/Leadership			**Communications**		
Administered	Coordinated	Directed	Clarified	Defined	Documented
Executed	Hired	Initiated	Edited	Interviewed	Presented
Overhauled	Planned	Produced	Publicized	Translated	Wrote
Refined	Supervised	Trained	Mediated	Interpreted	Reported
Guided	Helmed	Chaired	Conveyed	Delivered	Informed

https://www.coursera.org/articles/resume-action-words

Action Words

General Impact			Budgeting Impact		
Accomplished	Contributed	Enhanced	Decreased	Economized	Grew
Generated	Improved	Increased	Increased	Reduced	Saved
Renovated	Revamped	Streamlined	Prepared	Expanded	Improved
Produced	Earned	Influenced	Managed	Balanced	Recovered
Won	Realized	Acquired	Audited	Boosted	Minimized
Project Impact			**Customer Impact**		
Augmented	Boosted	Expanded	Acquired	Transformed	Ensured
Grew	Prioritized	Strengthened	Fulfilled	Captured	Negotiated
Optimized	Delivered	Managed	Improved	Increased	Established
Executed	Captured	Transformed	Remedied	Engaged	Assisted
Triaged	Coordinated	Steered	Resolved	Troubleshot	Reached

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